

A Trip That Changed My Mind: My Graduation Trip

Vocabulary, Grammar, and Practice Handout

Intermediate Level

THE TEXT (Corrected Version)

Note: Only grammar and spelling errors have been corrected. Corrections are shown in bold.

Last weekend, when I was checking the photos **on** my iPad with **the** hot milk tea, several photos **caught** my attention. As soon as I realized **those were** taken during my graduation trip, countless memories **surrounded** my mind, several gentle **smiles warmed** my heart, **and** the marvelous times from four months ago appeared clearly in my mind. **Although** the photos weren't taken very well, **they still preserved those** wonderful moments perfectly.

The first day of my graduation trip **was a visit to** the amusement park. **After a few hours'** drive, we finally arrived **at** Janfusun Fancyworld (劍湖山世界): G5, Skyscraper..... Scenes of **the** amusement park, indescribable in their own right, flashed before my eyes. I really enjoyed the time in the fantastic atmosphere with my friends. **Before** we arrived **at** the hotel, I **was immersed** in the happiness..... **The next** day, we **had a guided** tour **of** a museum. **Though** it **was** a bit **boring** for me, who wouldn't want to hang out with **their** best friends?

This **was** the last field trip in elementary school, the last opportunity to go crazy and **make** good memories with friends. "The friendships, memories, **and** knowledge you **have created** and **learned** in this school — all of you have finished **thousands of lessons**, overcome countless **competitions** and **exams**..... In fact, you are much better than you think."

The principal's **speech** brought this three-day, two-night trip to a close. The joy of counting down the last three **months concealed** six years of **depth**. I **got** three **reminders** from this wonderful trip: **first**, cherish every **moment that keeps** you **joyful**; **second**, life seems long on the surface, but it's actually very **short**; **last**, you are the best **of** all — be confident **in** yourself. **Look at** yourself **and** see how **far** your journey has **come**.

THE TEXT (Improved Version)

Note: This version improves clarity and flow while preserving the original voice and meaning.

Last weekend, while I was scrolling through photos on my iPad with a cup of hot milk tea, several pictures caught my eye. As soon as I realized they were taken during my graduation trip, countless memories flooded my mind and gentle smiles warmed my heart. The wonderful times from four months ago came alive once again. Although the photos were not taken very well, they still captured those precious moments perfectly.

On the first day of the trip, we visited an amusement park. After a few hours' drive, we finally arrived at Janfusun Fancyworld (劍湖山世界) — home to thrilling rides like the G5 and the Skyscraper. The scenes at the amusement park were indescribable, flashing before my eyes one after another. I truly enjoyed the fantastic atmosphere with my friends, and even before we arrived at the hotel, I was already soaked in happiness. The next day, we had a guided tour of a museum. Though it was a bit dull for me, who wouldn't want to spend time with their best friends?

This was the last field trip of elementary school — the last chance to let loose and create lasting memories with friends. “The friendships, memories, and knowledge you have built in this school — all of you have completed thousands of lessons and overcome countless challenges. In fact, you are much better than you think.”

The principal's speech brought this three-day, two-night trip to a close. The excitement of counting down the final three months had hidden six years of growth beneath it. I took away three reminders from this wonderful trip: first, cherish every moment that brings you joy; second, life may seem long on the surface, but it is actually very short; and last, you are the best version of yourself — be confident and look back at how far your journey has brought you.

PART A: VOCABULARY (12 Words)

Study the following vocabulary words from the text. Pay attention to how each word is used in context.

#	Word	Definition & Example from Text
1	scroll (v.)	to move through content on a screen by sliding up or down. "While I was scrolling through photos on my iPad..."
2	flood (v.)	to come in large amounts; to overwhelm. "Countless memories flooded my mind."
3	come alive (phr. v.)	to become vivid or feel real again. "The wonderful times came alive once again."
4	capture (v.)	to record or preserve a moment, image, or feeling. "They still captured those precious moments perfectly."
5	precious (adj.)	of great value; very dear or important. "Those precious moments."
6	thrilling (adj.)	causing a sudden feeling of excitement. "Home to thrilling rides like the G5."
7	indescribable (adj.)	too intense or extreme to describe in words. "The scenes at the amusement park were indescribable."
8	soaked (adj.)	completely filled or absorbed (figurative). "I was already soaked in happiness."
9	dull (adj.)	not interesting or exciting; boring. "Though it was a bit dull for me."
10	let loose (phr. v.)	to relax and enjoy oneself without restraint. "The last chance to let loose."
11	lasting (adj.)	continuing for a long time; enduring. "Create lasting memories with friends."

12	take away (phr. v.)	to learn or gain something from an experience. "I took away three reminders from this wonderful trip."
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Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best word to complete each sentence.

- After the concert, memories of the performance _____ her mind for days.
 - captured
 - scrolled
 - flooded
 - soaked
- The rollercoaster was absolutely _____ — my heart was racing the whole time!
 - dull
 - lasting
 - precious
 - thrilling
- She spent the evening _____ through social media on her phone.
 - flooding
 - scrolling
 - capturing
 - letting loose
- The beauty of the sunset was _____; no words could do it justice.
 - dull
 - precious
 - indescribable
 - lasting
- The photographer managed to _____ the exact moment the fireworks lit up the sky.
 - scroll
 - flood
 - take away
 - capture
- The lecture was so _____ that several students fell asleep.
 - thrilling
 - precious
 - dull
 - lasting

7. After working hard all semester, the students were ready to _____ at the graduation party.
- a) come alive
 - b) let loose
 - c) take away
 - d) soak
8. The little girl held the necklace carefully because it was very _____ to her.
- a) dull
 - b) lasting
 - c) precious
 - d) indescribable
9. The main _____ from the workshop was the importance of teamwork.
- a) scroll
 - b) takeaway
 - c) flood
 - d) capture
10. Good friendships can have a _____ impact on your happiness.
- a) dull
 - b) soaked
 - c) thrilling
 - d) lasting

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks

Complete each sentence with the correct word from the box.

scroll flood come alive capture precious thrilling

1. Old photographs have the power to make the past _____ before your eyes.
2. The _____ experience of bungee jumping is something I will never forget.
3. If you _____ down to the bottom of the page, you will find the answer.
4. After hearing the sad news, a wave of emotions _____ over her.
5. Every moment we spend together is _____; don't take it for granted.
6. The artist tried to _____ the feeling of a summer morning in her painting.

soaked dull let loose lasting indescribable take away

7. The joy I felt when I saw the ocean for the first time was _____.
8. After the rain, we were completely _____ from head to toe.
9. The one thing I _____ from his advice was to never give up.
10. Rainy afternoons can feel _____ if you don't have anything to do.
11. The children were excited to _____ at the school carnival.
12. A kind word can leave a _____ impression on someone.

PART B: GRAMMAR (5 Patterns)

Study the following grammar structures from the text.

Pattern 1: "home to + noun"

Form: Subject + be + home to + noun

Use: To describe what a place is known for or contains.

Example from text: *"Janfusun Fancyworld — home to thrilling rides like the G5 and the Skyscraper."*

More examples:

- This city is home to some of the best museums in the world.
- The island is home to over 200 species of birds.
- Our school is home to students from more than 30 countries.

Pattern 2: "one after another"

Form: Subject + verb + one after another

Use: To describe things happening in quick succession, one following the next.

Example from text: *"The scenes flashed before my eyes one after another."*

More examples:

- The problems kept coming one after another.
- She answered the questions one after another without hesitation.
- The guests arrived one after another throughout the evening.

Pattern 3: "the last chance to + verb"

Form: the last chance / opportunity to + base verb

Use: To express a final opportunity to do something.

Example from text: *"The last chance to let loose and create lasting memories."*

More examples:

- This is the last chance to sign up for the competition.
- He knew it was his last chance to apologize.
- Don't miss the last chance to visit the exhibition before it closes.

Pattern 4: "may seem + adjective, but + clause"

Form: Subject + may seem + adjective (+ on the surface / at first), but + subject + verb

Use: To contrast how something appears with how it really is.

Example from text: *"Life may seem long on the surface, but it is actually very short."*

More examples:

- The task may seem simple, but it requires a lot of patience.
- She may seem quiet, but she has a lot of strong opinions.
- The solution may seem obvious, but it took years to discover.

Pattern 5: "look back at + noun"

Form: look back at / on + noun (+ and + verb)

Use: To reflect on or remember past experiences.

Example from text: *"Look back at how far your journey has brought you."*

More examples:

- When I look back at my childhood, I realize how lucky I was.
- She looked back at her time in college with great fondness.
- Years from now, you'll look back at this moment and smile.

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer to complete each sentence.

1. The national park is _____ hundreds of rare plant species.
 - a) home to
 - b) home of
 - c) home for
 - d) home with
2. The fireworks went off _____ lighting up the night sky.
 - a) after one another
 - b) one after another
 - c) one by one another
 - d) another after one
3. This is your last _____ make a good impression at the interview.
 - a) chance of
 - b) chance for
 - c) chance to
 - d) chance at
4. The math problem may _____ easy, but it actually has several tricky steps.
 - a) seem to be
 - b) seems
 - c) seem
 - d) seeming
5. When she looked back _____ her school years, she felt grateful for her teachers.
 - a) to
 - b) at
 - c) for
 - d) in
6. Tokyo Disneyland is home _____ some of the most popular rides in Asia.
 - a) for
 - b) at
 - c) with
 - d) to
7. The students raised their hands one _____ to ask questions.
 - a) by another
 - b) after another
 - c) to another
 - d) from another

8. He may seem _____ on the outside, but he is actually very caring.

- a) coldly
- b) cold
- c) to cold
- d) being cold

9. Don't miss the last chance _____ the cherry blossoms this spring.

- a) seeing
- b) of seeing
- c) to see
- d) for see

10. Years from now, you'll look back _____ this trip and laugh.

- a) in
- b) for
- c) to
- d) at

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation

Rewrite each sentence using the pattern indicated in parentheses.

home to + noun

1. This museum has one of the largest dinosaur collections in the country. (This museum is...)

home to + noun

2. Our neighborhood has many excellent restaurants. (Our neighborhood is...)

one after another

3. The waves kept hitting the shore continuously. (The waves hit...)

one after another

4. The students presented their projects in quick succession. (The students presented...)

the last chance to + verb

5. This is your final opportunity to join the school band. (This is the last...)

the last chance to + verb

6. She knew she would not get another opportunity to apologize. (She knew it was...)

may seem + adj, but + clause

7. The book looks boring, but it is actually really interesting. (The book may...)

may seem + adj, but + clause

8. Learning a language looks difficult, but it gets easier with practice. (Learning a language may...)

look back at + noun

9. When I remember my first day of school, I feel happy. (When I look...)

look back at + noun

10. In the future, we will remember this moment with joy. (In the future, we'll look...)

ANSWER KEY

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. c) flooded 2. d) thrilling 3. b) scrolling 4. c) indescribable 5. d) capture
6. c) dull 7. b) let loose 8. c) precious 9. b) takeaway 10. d) lasting

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks

1. come alive 2. thrilling 3. scroll 4. flooded 5. precious 6. capture
7. indescribable 8. soaked 9. took away 10. dull 11. let loose 12. lasting

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. a) home to 2. b) one after another 3. c) chance to 4. c) seem 5. b) at
6. d) to 7. b) after another 8. b) cold 9. c) to see 10. d) at

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation (Sample Answers)

1. This museum is home to one of the largest dinosaur collections in the country.
2. Our neighborhood is home to many excellent restaurants.
3. The waves hit the shore one after another.
4. The students presented their projects one after another.
5. This is the last chance to join the school band.
6. She knew it was her last chance to apologize.
7. The book may seem boring, but it is actually really interesting.
8. Learning a language may seem difficult, but it gets easier with practice.
9. When I look back at my first day of school, I feel happy.
10. In the future, we'll look back at this moment with joy.